

Reading Concordances with Algorithms: a training course in key corpus linguistics methodology

Applications, the case of 'spatiotemporal analysis'

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Stephanie Evert & Michaela Mahlberg

being in some manner. The other dimensions were IN houses, on ships, on land, on water, on the
might be described as 'leaf' or 'sky' (or 'o') and IN a human temperate climate such as Britain expect
a powerful message put across by the curriculum IN most schools is that knowledge can be divided in
all like the trouble we had last year ago, when IN fact there were three lines, sections of which there
opportunities for one **READING** were notably IN the course of the day, for instance, in the activity
traditional hand-outs. **CONCORDANCES** IN several ways. One is that they will be much more
used often. "How old were you when you arrived IN Italy?" The American journalist broke into his throat
of Modern Art, keen in discovering what was good IN the arts of many ages and styles. As for works
who felt it necessary to take aside both captains IN our **21ST** minute and warn them about each line
relation has undergone several media revolutions IN the last **CENTURY** in particular, now that open
to some extent the ownership of the biggest hit IN each year, the aggregate market share of the film
focus from arts education in general, to one area IN particular, namely English lessons and the fiction
of the horse was, what I say dreamed up, and IN fact we had one or two horses. Clydesdale horses
under words. It was merely that he never wanted IN a tournament round to look anything which might

What we have learned so far from using CLiC & CQPweb?

- ☐ What strategies have you applied?
- ☐ How do you describe what you do?

Practices in different disciplines: survey of strategies

- 10 articles / case studies per discipline (40 total)
 - Lexicography
 - Data-driven learning
 - Corpus-assisted discourse studies
 - Literary stylistics
 - post-2000 publication; concrete examples
 - not included: studies using parallel or learner corpora
- Content analysis of methods sections (not literature review)
- Challenge: no systematic standards for describing methodology, mix of tool and method

Selecting

Sampling

A random **sample** of 100 concordances of each pair was, subsequently, **closely examined** for semantic prosody. **(Lexicography)**

Filtering

A concordance **query** for *carry out* with *research* in the context of three tokens to the left and to the right returned 160 hits, and most lines indeed exhibited the collocation *carry out research*, as exemplified in Figure 8, **(Lexicography)**

Selecting

Cleaning

As we were interested in lexical compounds linked to carbon dioxide rather than carbon as an element, such lexical combinations as, for example, *carbon molecule* or *carbon fibre* were removed. Nonsensical combinations as well as duplicates arising from differences in spelling such as *carbon offset* and *carbon-offset* were also eliminated. **(CADS)**

Threshold

We analysed the first 500 concordances of *seguire* chosen as “good examples” by the Sketch Engine (cf. Kilgarrieff et al., 2008) **(Lexicography)**

Ordering

Sorting

WordSmith Tools was mainly used for **sorting** and categorising concordances because it allows the analyst to assign values to lines and to move easily from concordance to text. [**Figure 3** shows sorting by 1R] **(CADS)**

The students were then instructed to search for the preceding underlined word *friendship* using IntelliText, and to examine the concordance lines to identify which preposition should follow *friendship* in this context, by **sorting** right or left contexts in keyword-in-context (KWIC) lines. **(DDL)**

Ordering

Ranking

We analysed the **first 500** concordances of *seguire* **chosen as “good examples”** by the Sketch Engine (cf. Kilgarriff et al., 2008)
(Lexicography)

Reading Concordances R21 Project

What do users do to organise concordance lines for interpretation? What drives the choices they make, beyond their intuition and the features of concordancing tools they are familiar with?

Our goals:

1. **Develop a consistent methodology** of concordance reading strategies and suggesting a transparent terminology that describes tool-independent principles of reading concordances.
2. **Develop a concordance software framework and new algorithms** that support a consistent concordance reading methodology: the **FlexiConc** library
3. **Conduct case studies** to illustrate the usefulness of the approach

The FlexiConc approach

1. Selecting

- “zoom in” on a **subset** of the concordance lines
- either focus on specific pattern or discard unwanted lines

} **subset**

2. Ordering

- a) Sorting: **reorder** lines based on pairwise comparison
- b) Ranking: **reorder** lines based on preference score

} **arrangement**

3. Grouping

- a) Partitioning: **groups** based on common property
- b) Clustering: (nested) **groups** based on pairwise similarity

Hands-on: FlexiConc in CLiC basics

<https://clic-fiction.com/>

- We go back to the eyes in CLiC examples to think about extending the ways of looking at the data.
- With the help of various algorithms provided by FlexiConc.
- https://github.com/reading-concordances/teaching/blob/main/course/handouts/flexiconc_clic_handout_2026.pdf

Extending the search for body language patterns

Search words: *cheeks, cheek, neck, fingers, ear*

Focus on non-quotes

Showing 1 to 50 of 1,575 entries,

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ID	Left	Node	Right	Book	In bk.
0	one tinge of crimson flushed the waxen whiteness of her	cheeks;	not one shadow of brown redeemed the pale insipidity of	LadyAud	
1	at half-past nine o'clock, singing a little Scotch melody, her	cheeks	tinged with as delicate a pink as the pale hue	LadyAud	
2	Audley's face; the pretty, roseate flush faded out from her	cheeks,	and left them waxen white, and angry flashes lightened in	LadyAud	
3	were of that sunless, flaxen hue which generally accompanies pink	cheeks	and white eyelashes. She had been a rustic beauty, perhaps	LadyAud	
4	clinging about him, kissed the dirty tears from his faded	cheeks.	¶ "Don't be sorry for me, gran'pa," he said; "I am	LadyAud	
5	The unnatural color still burnt like a flame in her	cheeks;	the unnatural light still glittered in her eyes. The excitement	LadyAud	
6	better nor half the folks as are growed up." ¶ Maggie's	cheeks	began to flush with triumphant excitement. She thought Mr. Riley	mill	
7	lavishing so many warm kisses on it that the waxen	cheeks	had a wasted, unhealthy appearance. ¶ "Did you ever hear the	mill	
8	stared with the roundest of eyes above the reddest of	cheeks;	but was now entirely defaced by a long career of	mill	
9	as much alike as goslings,--a lad with light-brown hair,	cheeks	of cream and roses, full lips, indeterminate nose and eyebrows	mill	
10	for company, and they ate together and rubbed each other's	cheeks	and brows and noses together, while they ate, with a	mill	
11	hands, hurting them with her large rings, and kissing their	cheeks	much against their desire. "Look up, Tom, look up. Boys	mill	
12	said Maggie, giving a little stamp with her foot. Her	cheeks	were quite flushed. ¶ The black locks were so thick, nothing	mill	
13	and still Tom laughed and clapped his hands, and Maggie's	cheeks	began to pale, and her lips to tremble a little	mill	
14	turn towards the same point as her own, and Maggie's	cheeks	and ears began to burn, while uncle Glegg, a kind-looking	mill	
15	Maggie, my dear; don't make yourself so ugly!" and Tom's	cheeks	were looking particularly brilliant as a relief to his best	mill	
16	about Columbus?" ¶ Maggie's eyes had begun to sparkle and her	cheeks	to flush,--she was really beginning to instruct the gypsies	mill	
17	with a pair of amiable blue-gray eyes and round pink	cheeks	that refused to look formidable, let him frown as he	mill	
18	chair, with the big tears ready to roll down her	cheeks,	quite blinded to the presence of Bob, who was looking	mill	
19	became ambitious. The exercise brought the warm blood into her	cheeks,	and made her inclined to take her lesson merrily. ¶ "I	mill	
20	was the instinctive vent of strong excitement. Her eyes and	cheeks	had an almost feverish brilliancy; her head was thrown backward	mill	
21	must have come again by the river. Maggie felt her	cheeks	glowing and her heart beating; it was natural she should	mill	

FlexiConc

Search in CLiC

Search the corpora:

19C - 19th Century Reference Corpus ✕

Only in subsets:

Non-quotes

Search for terms:

cheeks cheek neck fingers ear

☐ Whole phrase

☒ Any word

Add annotation...



1



Add algorithm...

Save as named path:

e.g. 'sample'

Save

Subsets

Clusters

Keywords

Counts